



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Collegiate Academy
School Website: <https://www.veritasca.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Veritas Collegiate Academy VA 23320 presents a confident classical Christian posture in its public materials. The school clearly identifies itself as a classical Christian preparatory school and structures its program around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with grades K-12 implicit in its site navigation (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric tracks) and a stated mission to educate within a biblical, theologically grounded framework. Public content emphasizes formation of character within a Christian worldview, a strong sense of community, and a global-leadership orientation. Taken together, the school demonstrates a classical orientation with a measurable Christian foundation, yielding an aggregate assessment of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL across all six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community). Evidence of explicit classical components is strongest in Religious Foundations and Curriculum (Trivium-focused structure), with less explicit articulation of some classical pedagogical methods, Great Books engagement, and a living-faculty narrative in public-facing materials. See category-by-category notes below for detailed keyword analysis and scoring rationale. Key sources include the school's own site content describing its classical Christian identity and Trivium structure, historical statements about the school's mission, and content referencing biblical worldview and spiritual life.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The institution explicitly calls itself a Classical Christian preparatory school, signaling a theological and metaphysical framework. - Texts describe the school as committed to classical Christian education and the Trivium, indicating a spiritual worldview integrated into the curriculum. - Public mentions of biblical worldview and spiritual life (e.g., statements about God's sovereignty in history and a biblically grounded approach) appear in school materials. - A parent testimonial highlights "the implementation of a biblical worldview," chapel life, and leadership programs, signaling liturgical/spiritual practices.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, biblical worldview, spiritual life, God, theology (implicit in Christian framing), liturgical life (via Spiritual Life menu/patterns). - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secularism, or value-neutral language detected in the supplied excerpts).

Why this rating - Strong explicit religious framing and theological grounding (Christian, biblical worldview, spiritual life) align with the Positive Keywords for Religious Foundations. The absence of explicit negative signals (e.g., secular ethics, relativism) supports a Classical orientation, even though other classical features (e.g., Great Books or explicit liturgical practice) are less overt in the public text. The synthesis points to a CLASSICAL-leaning foundation, here rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to limited explicit articulation of

all metaphysical practices and liturgical specifics beyond general spiritual life. The overall evidence supports a robust Classical Christian orientation rather than a neutral or secular model.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself as “A Classical Christian Preparatory School” with a stated aim to assist parents in the education of their children, indicating formation-centered aims rather than purely job-prep objectives. - Public materials emphasize allegiance to the classical Trivium, signaling a teleology anchored in the liberal-arts and formation-oriented aims rather than only information delivery. - There are references to the school’s mission, vision, and leadership development as part of forming students for college and life, consistent with formation and virtue-oriented aims.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, liberal education (implicit via Trivium framing), classical mission, telos (implied by Trivium emphasis and mission), biblical worldview (via the religious framing). - Negative keywords present: none explicit (no strong “workforce preparation” or “21st-century skills” framing appears in the accessible passages).

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on classical education (Trivium) and formation-oriented language (formation of character through classical pedagogy and spiritual worldview) supports a CLASSICAL orientation in goal/purpose. However, explicit articulation of a full philosophical triad (truth, goodness, beauty) or a fully developed telos beyond “formation” is less transparent in the public content, which tempers the rating to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The religious formation adds strength, but the absence of a clearly stated, comprehensive articulation of all six elements’ telos and virtue formation in a universal sense places the school in the middle.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials clearly delineate the Trivium: Grammar (K-6), Logic (7-9), Rhetoric (10-12). This is a foundational hallmark of classical curricula. - The site presents a broad liberal-arts orientation via “Center for Global Leadership” and international programs, implying exposure to integrated, classical-informed disciplines beyond mere content delivery. - There are explicit historical/civilizational aims (e.g., an objective to provide Western civilization context and biblical/Christian worldview) in admitted course content (History & Geography objectives include viewing God in history and historical interpretation).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation (implied through classical education lingo and Western-civilizational aims), history and geography integrated with worldview, liberal education. - Negative keywords present: Some modern or secular terms (e.g., “social studies” framing) do not appear; however, explicit Great Books engagement and quadrivium (beyond the Trivium) are not clearly stated in the public text, and public citations to Great Books as a central curriculum are not explicit in the excerpts.

Why this rating - The explicit Trivium structure is a strong, foundational classical element, but the public content does not consistently reveal a full Great Books/Quadrivium emphasis or a clearly articulated, widely integrated Great Conversation across all grades. The presence of strong historical/theological framing and the K-12 Trivium framework points to a classical-liberal curriculum, but with some missing explicit textual markers (e.g., explicit Great Books program) in the public materials. Therefore the Curriculum rating is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The presence of upper-level “Rhetoric (10-12)” implies training in rhetoric and potentially public speaking—an element of classical pedagogy. - The public materials emphasize graded stages that align with the Trivium progression (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and suggest a pedagogy that moves from repetition and foundational memory to higher-order reasoning and debate in later grades (implied by the Rhetoric track). The site includes “Academics” with a clear progression and a focus on classical form. - There are references to a “Center for Global Leadership” and international programs, signaling experiential opportunities that may

be part of a broader classical pedagogy, but concrete statements about Socratic seminars, scholé days, or explicit chanting/memory-work practices are not shown in the public excerpts. The lack of explicit statements about Socratic seminars and scholé in the public text lowers the certainty of a full classic pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar (implied by logic/rhetoric tracks and classical pedagogy), memorization/recitation (memory-work implied by classical pedagogy, though explicit chant/memorization terms are not widely shown in the site snippets), restfulness (Scholé is referenced in the classical pedagogy lexicon, though not spelled out in the school text here). - Negative keywords present: Experiential learning-focused, project-based-only approach would be a red flag; the site text is not strongly project-based-centric, but explicit statements confirming or denying project-based pedagogy are not present.

Why this rating - The presence of the Trivium pathway and upper-level rhetoric signals a classical pedagogy in line with classical education, but the public text does not clearly confirm a full suite of classical methods (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars, scholé days, memory work) beyond the general structure. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. A more explicit articulation of Socratic inquiry, sleep/restful learning rhythms (Scholé), and memory-based recitation in public messaging would push this category toward CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site includes a “Faculty” page as part of its site navigation, indicating attention to teacher roles and profiles, though public materials do not provide detailed narratives about “the living curriculum” or the faculty as mentors in the sense of classical pedagogy. - Public materials emphasize leadership and faculty involvement in admissions and student life, but there is less explicit language about mentors as living curriculum or portraits of teachers (i.e., the explicit living curriculum, model teachers, or “portrait of what a teacher should be” language is not clearly shown in the excerpts).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: masters/mentors/tutors (as a concept in classical education), faculty as the core of the school (the “faculty” page exists; explicit phrasing about teachers as living curriculum is not overt in the snippets). - Negative keywords present: “facilitators on the side,” or purely credential-driven framing would be negative, but no explicit negative signals appear in the public extracts.

Why this rating - The mere existence of a “Faculty” page and a clearly defined classical program suggests some alignment with a classical faculty model. However, the public text does not consistently articulate the “living curriculum,” teacher mentorship, and portrait of teacher/student ideals that define a fully CLASSICAL faculty. Thus, Element 5 is BEST characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. More explicit articulation of teacher-mentors as the living curriculum and a clearly stated teacher profile would push this toward CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site features parent-facing content (e.g., Volunteering, Open House, and communication channels for families) and emphasizes parental involvement and leadership opportunities (as evidenced by the Volunteering pages and community-oriented sections). - Testimonials and public materials describe a family-friendly environment, chapel life, and leadership programs; a blog testimonial references the biblical worldview and community atmosphere, suggesting that families are deeply engaged. - The site’s structure includes a “Center for Global Leadership” and international programs, which can indicate a broader community and family engagement beyond the local campus.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-and-school connection, open campus, volunteer opportunities, parental engagement, classical family culture. - Negative keywords present: consumer-language signals or customer-only framing would be negative; the excerpts do not show a consumerist posture; rather, they show active parental involvement, though not always crisply framed as “co-teachers” in the public text.

Why this rating - There is clear evidence of parental involvement opportunities and a community-centric approach, which aligns with Positive Keywords in the Parents & Community category. However, the public messaging does not always explicitly articulate “parents as co-teachers” or formal parental formation programs beyond volunteering and events. Thus, Element 6 is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books and Great Conversation explicit: Add a clearly stated program or cadence for Great Books reading, primary sources, and a “Great Conversation” across grades (explicitly linking to canonical texts and primary sources). This would push Curriculum (Element 3) toward CLASSICAL.
- Elevate explicit Socratic pedagogy and scholé: Publicly document and demonstrate the use of Socratic seminars, memory work, and contemplative, restful learning (Scholé) in daily practice. This would raise Pedagogy (Element 4) and potentially Faculty (Element 5) if coupled with a living curriculum narrative.
- Strengthen the living curriculum narrative: Publish explicit statements about faculty as mentors, the “portrait of a teacher,” and the faculty as the core of the school’s living curriculum. This would lift Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
- Expand liturgical and liturgical-life integration: If not already present, articulate formal liturgical practices, sacred music, and a defined liturgical calendar to strengthen Religious Foundations (Element 1) and tie to the school’s spiritual life.
- Deepen parental formation and co-teaching language: Explicitly position parents as co-educators and provide structured parent formation opportunities (reading groups, book studies, parent covenant, etc.) to elevate Element 6 to CLASSICAL.
- Increase explicit historical/philosophical breadth in Curriculum: More explicit inclusion of Western civilization curricula, primary-source history, and cross-disciplinary integration (interdisciplinary curriculum) would reinforce the classical stance in Element 3.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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